IT Governance Assessment and Redesign

Gynae360 – Fertility & Laparoscopy Centre

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Introduction and Organisational Context

This report presents an assessment of the current IT governance environment at Gynae360, a private healthcare provider in Kingston, Jamaica, and provides recommendations to strengthen governance structures, improve decision-making, and align IT capabilities with business and regulatory requirements.

Gynae360 delivers specialised medical services in gynaecology, obstetrics, and fertility. The organisation operates under a highly centralized leadership structure, with executive authority vested in a single individual serving as both Chief Executive Officer and Chairman of the Board. Operational activities are supported by clinical, administrative, and laboratory functions, including diagnostic and research capabilities.

The organisation demonstrates a clear recognition of the strategic importance of information technology in supporting clinical operations and business objectives. However, governance practices remain informal and are not supported by structured frameworks or defined governance mechanisms.

IT capabilities are fully outsourced to an external service provider, Lighthouse Technologies, which functions as the organisation's de facto IT department. For the purposes of this assessment, the head of the external provider is treated as the equivalent of a Chief Information Officer (CIO), responsible for technical advisory, infrastructure design, and system implementation.

IT Decision-Making and Governance Practices

IT Strategy and Business Alignment

Strategic direction is defined at the executive level, with the CEO retaining full authority over business and technology decisions. IT is used primarily to support operational needs, including system maintenance and data security, rather than as a driver of strategic transformation.

Technology decisions are made through informal consultation between the CEO and the CIO (external provider), supported by independent research and external input where necessary. There is no formal governance mechanism to ensure consistent alignment between IT initiatives and organisational strategy.

IT Budgeting and Investment Allocation

IT budgeting is based on historical expenditure patterns, market pricing, and anticipated operational or expansion requirements. A baseline allocation is established annually to cover recurring IT costs, including infrastructure maintenance, subscriptions, and support services.

Significant investments, such as system upgrades or new technology implementations, are evaluated on a case-by-case basis. Final approval authority rests with the CEO, with input provided by the CIO. There is no formal investment governance framework or standardised evaluation criteria for assessing technology initiatives.

Allocation of IT expenditure within approved budgets is largely delegated to the CIO, except where specific direction is provided by executive leadership. Additional funding requests are submitted through vendor quotations and are subject to executive approval.

IT Architecture and Infrastructure Governance

Responsibility for IT architecture and infrastructure design resides with the CIO, who develops solutions based on organisational requirements and budget constraints. Decisions are primarily driven by vendor recommendations and practical implementation considerations.

While infrastructure design is expected to comply with applicable regulatory requirements, including the Jamaica Data Protection Act (2020), there is no formally documented architecture framework, standardisation model, or governance oversight process to ensure consistency, scalability, and long-term sustainability.

Business Application Governance

Responsibility for business application selection is split between executive leadership and the CIO.

Administrative and operational systems are typically recommended by the CIO and implemented with minimal formal evaluation. In contrast, clinical systems, including electronic health records and specialised medical applications, are selected directly by the CEO.

This dual approach lacks a structured evaluation framework and does not incorporate formal governance processes to assess system integration, data management implications, or regulatory compliance requirements.

Existing IT Governance Structures

There are currently no formal IT governance structures within Gynae360. Governance activities are limited to executive oversight and informal coordination between the CEO and the external IT provider.

The organisation does not operate an IT Steering Committee, formal governance board, or structured decision-making body responsible for overseeing IT strategy, investment prioritisation, or risk management.

In addition, there are no documented governance processes, policies, or control frameworks to guide IT operations, manage risk, or ensure compliance with data protection requirements.

As a result, IT governance is reactive, highly centralized, and dependent on individual decision-making rather than institutionalised governance practices.

IT Governance Effectiveness

IT Governance effectiveness indicators	Done poorly/not at all (0)	Done somewhat poorly (1)	Done somewhat well (2)	Done well/ completely (3)
There is thoughtful variation among the decision styles used for different IT domains			X	
'C' level executives are involved in IT governance.		X		
Executives can accurately describe IT governance.		X		
Formal executive committees and communications underpin IT governance arrangements	X			
Transparent, formal exception processes are in place.		X		
Serious tracking of IT's business value, projects and resources consumed is undertaken.	X			

Overall Governance Maturity Score 5/18

IT Governance Arrangements & Mechanisms

Domains	Principles		Architecture		Infrastructure		Business Applications		Investment & Priorities	
Styles	**Input**	**Decision**	**Input**	**Decision**	**Input**	**Decision**	**Input**	**Decision**	**Input**	**Decision**
Business Monarchy		✓	✓		✓			✓		✓
IT Monarchy	✓					✓	✓			
Feudal										
Federal										
Duopoly				✓					✓	
Anarchy										

IT Governance Gaps and Risk Assessment

The current IT governance environment, while typical of smaller organisations, presents significant structural and operational weaknesses that impact governance effectiveness, increase risk exposure, and limit the organisation's ability to scale and operate efficiently.

Absence of Formal Governance Structures

The organisation does not operate a formal IT governance framework. There is no IT Steering Committee, no defined governance bodies, and no documented roles, responsibilities, or decision rights.

IT decision-making is highly centralized at the executive level, with strategic direction dependent on individual judgement rather than structured governance processes. As a result, IT priorities are not formally communicated or consistently managed across the organisation.

This structure introduces key risks, including:

- inconsistent and non-repeatable decision-making
- over-dependence on key individuals
- limited transparency and accountability
- lack of continuity in the event of leadership changes or organisational expansion

Lack of Strategic Alignment Between IT and Business Objectives

IT currently operates as a support function focused on system maintenance and data security, with limited integration into broader organisational strategy.

There is no formal IT strategy or structured engagement between executive leadership and IT stakeholders to align technology initiatives with business priorities, including planned expansion and service development.

This results in:

- underutilisation of IT as a strategic enabler
- inefficient implementation of business initiatives
- missed opportunities to improve operational efficiency and patient service delivery

Informal IT Investment and Vendor Selection Processes

IT investment decisions are made on an ad hoc basis without a formal evaluation or approval framework. Vendor selection is based on informal recommendations, independent research, or subjective judgement.

There are no defined criteria for evaluating technology investments, such as cost-benefit analysis, risk assessment, or alignment with strategic objectives.

This creates risks including:

- inconsistent investment decisions
- suboptimal vendor selection
- potential bias in decision-making
- lack of accountability for technology outcomes

Lack of Documented IT Architecture and Standards

The organisation does not maintain formal IT architecture documentation or defined infrastructure standards. System design and integration decisions are primarily vendor-driven and based on practical compatibility testing.

The absence of a structured architecture framework introduces:

- increased technical debt
- risk of system incompatibility
- limited scalability as the organisation grows
- lack of long-term technology planning

Absence of IT Policies, Procedures, and Control Frameworks

There are no formally documented IT policies, procedures, or governance controls governing system usage, data handling, or security practices.

While there is some awareness of data protection obligations under the Jamaica Data Protection Act (2020), this is not supported by formalised policies or enforcement mechanisms.

This results in:

- increased risk of human error
- inconsistent application of security practices
- limited ability to enforce access controls and compliance requirements

- exposure to data protection and regulatory risks

Lack of IT Performance Measurement and Monitoring

The organisation does not implement performance measurement mechanisms to assess IT effectiveness. There are no defined KPIs, service metrics, or structured reporting processes.

IT incidents are not formally tracked, analysed, or used to inform continuous improvement.

This limits the organisation's ability to:

- Evaluate the value delivered by IT investments
- Identify recurring operational issues
- establish accountability for IT performance
- improve service quality over time

Governance Model Assessment

The current governance model reflects a Business Monarchy structure with elements of IT Monarchy, where:

- Executive leadership retains control over strategic decisions and investment priorities
- Technical decisions are delegated to the external IT provider

Overall, the governance environment is highly centralized, informal, and reactive, with limited institutional governance mechanisms in place to support structured decision-making, risk management, or regulatory compliance.

Governance Principles for Redesign

Based on stakeholder input and organisational priorities, including planned clinical expansion and improved service delivery, the following principles should guide IT governance going forward:

Clinical Outcomes and Service Quality

IT must directly support clinical excellence, patient safety, and quality of care. Systems must enable accurate data management, efficient workflows, and reliable service delivery.

Business Value Realisation

IT investments must be evaluated based on measurable business outcomes, including operational efficiency, revenue impact, and patient experience. Formal business cases and performance metrics should be established for all significant initiatives.

Data Protection and Regulatory Compliance

Given the sensitivity of healthcare data, data protection and cybersecurity must be embedded into all IT decisions. Systems and processes must align with the Jamaica Data Protection Act (2020), including appropriate controls for data access, storage, and processing.

Scalability and Future Growth

Technology infrastructure must support organisational growth, including expansion of clinical services such as IVF. Systems should be designed for scalability, integration, and increased data processing requirements.

Structured and Transparent Decision-Making

IT governance must transition from informal, individual-driven decisions to structured processes involving relevant stakeholders. Decision-making should be transparent, documented, and supported by defined governance mechanisms.

Proposed IT Governance Model

To address the identified gaps, a structured governance framework is recommended, aligned with established governance models.

The proposed structure adopts a hybrid governance approach combining:

- Business Monarchy for strategic direction and investment decisions
- IT Monarchy for technical architecture and infrastructure decisions
- Duopoly governance for business applications and operational systems

Under this model:

- Executive leadership retains accountability for strategic priorities
- IT specialists provide technical authority and implementation oversight
- Key decisions are supported through structured collaboration between business and technical stakeholders

This approach strengthens governance maturity, improves alignment between IT and business objectives, and introduces accountability, transparency, and regulatory compliance into the organisation's IT operations.

IT Governance Congruence Framework – Gynae360

Enterprise Goals	IT Governance Style	IT Governance Mechanisms	Desired IT Behaviors	Performance Measures	IT Metrics & Accountabilities
Establish IVF centre and expand clinical services	Business Monarchy for IT principles and major IT investments	IT Steering Committee involving CEO, CIO, and clinical leadership	Treat IT investments as business initiatives for delivery	Faster introduction of new clinical services	Time required to deploy new clinical systems
Improve patient service and customer experience	Duopoly governance for business applications (CEO + CIO decisions)	Formal IT project evaluation and approval process	Collaboration between clinical staff and IT when implementing new systems	Improved patient satisfaction	Patient satisfaction ratings and service response times
Increase operational efficiency in patient scheduling and administration	Duopoly governance between management and IT specialists	Implementation of patient management and administrative systems	Use of integrated digital systems rather than manual processes	Reduced administrative workload	Reduction in manual administrative tasks and scheduling errors
Protect patient data and ensure regulatory compliance	IT Monarchy for architecture, infrastructure, and cybersecurity	Formal IT security policies and cybersecurity oversight	Proactive cybersecurity management and secure handling of patient data	Reduced security risks and regulatory compliance	Number of security incidents and compliance audit results

Support organisational growth and scalability	Business Monarchy for IT investment priorities	IT strategy and technology roadmap	Long-term technology planning rather than reactive IT purchases	Sustainable growth supported by scalable IT systems	Infrastructure uptime and system capacity utilization

Exhibit 2: Proposed IT Governance Arrangements Matrix

Domains	IT Governance Mapping (Styles v Domas)									
	Principles		Architecture		Infrastructure		Business Applications		Investment & Priorities	
	Input	Decision	Input	Decision	Input	Decision	Input	Decision	Input	Decision
Business Monarchy	IT Steering Committee		CEO / Board				Clinical Leadership		IT Steering Committee	
IT Monarchy			IT provider / CIO		IT provider / CIO		CIO		CEO / Board	
Feudal	CEO + IT Steering Committee				IT provider / CIO				CEO + Board + CIO	
Federal	CEO + IT Steering Committee		CEO + CIO							
Duopoly			CEO + CIO		CEO + CIO				CEO + Board + CIO	
Anarchy			CEO + CIO		CEO + CIO		CEO + CIO			

Recommended IT Governance Structures and Mechanisms

IT Steering Committee

The establishment of an IT Steering Committee is a critical governance mechanism required to introduce structured oversight, accountability, and alignment between technology initiatives and organisational strategy.

This committee will function as the primary governance body responsible for IT strategy, investment prioritisation, and performance oversight. It will ensure that all technology initiatives are aligned with business objectives, including clinical service delivery, planned expansion (e.g., IVF services), operational efficiency, and compliance with regulatory requirements such as the Jamaica Data Protection Act (JDPA).

The committee will also serve as the central point for integrating business, clinical, and technical perspectives into IT decision-making.

Decision-Making Responsibilities

The IT Steering Committee will be responsible for:

- Reviewing and approving major IT initiatives and capital investments
- Prioritising IT projects based on strategic value, risk, and resource constraints
- Defining IT governance principles and strategic priorities
- Monitoring delivery, performance, and outcomes of IT initiatives
- Ensuring compliance with applicable regulatory requirements, including JDPA obligations related to data protection and security
- Overseeing risk identification and mitigation for technology implementations

Membership

The committee should include cross-functional representation to ensure balanced decision-making:

- Chief Executive Officer (Chair)
- Board representative
- CIO or external IT service provider (Lighthouse Technologies)
- Clinical representative (senior physician or medical administrator)
- Operations / administrative manager

This structure ensures that IT decisions reflect both operational requirements and technical feasibility while maintaining executive oversight.

IT Architecture and Infrastructure Governance

A formal governance mechanism is required to manage IT architecture and infrastructure decisions in a structured and scalable manner.

This function ensures that all systems are designed, implemented, and maintained in alignment with organisational requirements, cybersecurity standards, and data protection obligations under the JDPA.

It also reduces risks associated with vendor-driven architecture, system incompatibility, and uncontrolled technical debt.

Decision-Making Responsibilities

- Define and maintain enterprise IT architecture standards
- Establish infrastructure and system integration guidelines
- Evaluate and select appropriate infrastructure and cybersecurity solutions
- Ensure system interoperability, reliability, and scalability
- Support integration of clinical, administrative, and financial systems

Membership

- CIO or external IT provider
- Systems administrators / technical consultants
- Information security specialists (as required)

This function is primarily technical but must operate within governance parameters defined by executive leadership.

IT Investment and Project Governance

A structured governance framework is required to ensure that IT investments are evaluated, approved, and monitored using consistent and transparent criteria.

This function introduces discipline into capital allocation decisions and ensures that investments deliver measurable business and operational value.

Decision-Making Responsibilities

- Evaluate proposals for new systems, upgrades, and technology initiatives
- Assess cost, risk, expected benefits, and regulatory implications
- Prioritise investments based on strategic alignment and organisational impact
- Monitor project execution, delivery timelines, and outcomes

Membership

- Chief Executive Officer
- Board representatives (for significant investments)
- CIO or external IT provider
- IT Steering Committee members

Decision authority remains with executive leadership, supported by structured technical and governance input.

IT Policy and Risk Governance

Formal policy and risk governance structures are required to ensure that IT operations are secure, compliant, and consistently managed.

This function is critical in a healthcare environment where sensitive personal and medical data is processed and must be protected in accordance with the Jamaica Data Protection Act.

Decision-Making Responsibilities

- Develop and maintain IT policies, standards, and procedures
- Implement and monitor cybersecurity controls and risk management practices
- Ensure compliance with data protection regulations, including JDPA requirements
- Define and enforce access control mechanisms (e.g., role-based access)
- Oversee incident response, backup, and disaster recovery processes

Membership

- CIO or external IT provider
- CEO / executive management
- Compliance or administrative personnel responsible for regulatory oversight

This function establishes accountability for data protection, operational risk, and regulatory compliance across the organisation.

Management Report: Findings and Recommendations

Introduction

This assessment evaluated the current IT governance environment at Gynae360 and identified structural and operational gaps affecting governance effectiveness, decision-making, and strategic alignment.

A redesigned governance framework has been proposed to introduce formal structures, improve accountability, and align IT capabilities with organisational objectives.

Summary of Key Findings

The organisation currently operates with a highly informal and centralised IT governance model.

Key findings include:

- Absence of formal IT governance structures and defined decision rights
- Centralised decision-making concentrated at the executive level
- Lack of formal IT strategy aligned with business objectives
- Informal and inconsistent IT investment evaluation processes
- Absence of documented IT architecture and governance standards
- Lack of formal policies, procedures, and control frameworks
- No defined performance measurement or reporting mechanisms

While functional at a small scale, this model introduces risks related to scalability, transparency, consistency, and regulatory compliance.

Recommendations

To address these gaps, the following actions are recommended:

- Establish an IT Steering Committee to provide strategic oversight and governance
- Develop a formal IT strategy and technology roadmap aligned with organisational objectives
- Implement structured IT investment evaluation and approval processes
- Define and document IT policies covering security, data protection, access control, and procurement
- Introduce governance mechanisms for architecture, infrastructure, and system integration
- Implement performance measurement frameworks, including KPIs and reporting structures

These measures will improve governance maturity, strengthen decision-making, and ensure alignment between IT and business priorities.

Importance of IT Governance for Gynae360

Strengthening IT governance will enable the organisation to transition from an informal, reactive model to a structured and strategic approach to technology management.

This is particularly critical as the organisation expands its clinical services and increases its reliance on digital systems for patient care, data management, and operational efficiency.

Effective governance will:

- Improve transparency and accountability in decision-making
- Reduce operational and cybersecurity risks
- Ensure compliance with JDPA and other regulatory requirements
- Enable scalable and sustainable growth
- Support improved patient outcomes and service delivery

Summary

The current IT governance environment at Gynae360 is informal and highly centralised, limiting its ability to support long-term growth and operational efficiency.

The proposed governance framework introduces structured decision-making, formal accountability, and alignment with business and regulatory requirements.

Implementation of these recommendations will position the organisation to leverage technology more effectively while managing risk and ensuring compliance.